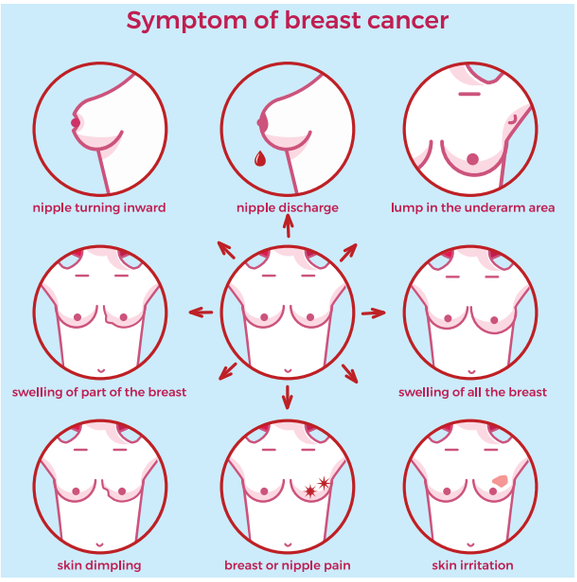
Causes

- No definite cause
- Hormones and genetics play some role in causing breast cancer

Risk Factors

- Breast cancer may be seen after the age of 50
- Personal or family history of breast cancer may lead to a main cause
- Persons with early menarche may have more chances of getting breast cancer
- Females who are not having children are more prone to breast cancer
- Late maternal age at first birth
- Late menopause also one of the cause
- Exposure to ionizing radiation
- Obesity also rarely cause breast cancer

Signs and Symptoms



- Non tender, fixed, hard mass with irregular border in the breast
- Peau d' orange (orange peel) appearance of the skin seen on the breast
- Nipple retraction in advanced cancer
- Ulcerating and fungating lesions

Investigation

- Self breast examination
- Fine needle biopsy
- Open biopsy
- Incisional biopsy
- Core biopsy
- Histologic examination

Management

Surgical Management:

- Mastectomy – removal of the affected breast
- Modified radical mastectomy
- Breast conservation surgery
- Lumpectomy
- Partial mastectomy
- Segmental mastectomy
- Quadrantectomy. (Axillary lymph node dissection)
- Radiotherapy
- Chemotherapy
- Hormonal therapy
- Bone marrow transplantation

Nursing Management

- Family support

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